

058. Chapter 4 Verses 38-41

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 4.38

न हि ज्ञानेन सदृशं पवित्रमिह विद्यते ।
तत्स्वयं योगसंसिद्धः कालेनात्मनि विन्दति ॥ ३८ ॥

na hi jñānena sadṛśaṃ
pavitramiha vidyate |
tatsvayaṃ yogasaṃsiddhaḥ
kālenātmani vindati ||

◆ na hi – not indeed; jñānena – to knowledge; sadṛśaṃ – like/equal; ◆ pavitram – purifier; iha – here (in this world); vidyate – exists; ◆ tat – that; svayaṃ – himself; yoga-saṃsiddhaḥ – one perfected in Yoga; ◆ kālena – in time; ātmani – in the Self; vindati – finds/attains.

**Indeed there is nothing so pure as Knowledge in this world.
He who is perfected in Nishkama Karma finds that wisdom
by himself in Atma in due season.**

VERSE 4.39

श्रद्धावान् लभते ज्ञानं तत्परः संयतेन्द्रियः ।
ज्ञानं लब्ध्वा परां शान्तिमचिरेणाधिगच्छति ॥ ३९ ॥

śraddhāvāṁllabhate jñānaṁ
tatparaḥ saṁyatendriyaḥ |
jñānaṁ labdhvā parāṁ śāntim
acireṇādhigacchati ||

◆ śraddhāvān – the man of faith; labhate – obtains; jñānam – knowledge; ◆ tatparaḥ – devoted to it; saṁyata-indriyaḥ – who has subdued the senses; ◆ jñānam – knowledge; labdhvā – having obtained; parāṁ – supreme; śāntim – peace; ◆ acireṇa – quickly; adhigacchati – attains.

**The man of faith, having Knowledge as his supreme goal
having controlled the senses, obtains knowledge of Atma,
and having obtained that enjoys everlasting peace.**

VERSE 4.40

अज्ञश्चाश्रद्धधानश्च संशयात्मा विनश्यति ।
नायं लोकोऽस्ति न परो न सुखं संशयात्मनः ॥ 40 ॥

ajñāścāśraddadhānaśca
saṁśayaātmā vinaśyati |
nāyaṁ loka'styaparo
na sukhaṁ saṁśayaātmanaḥ ||

◆ ajñāḥ – the ignorant; ca – and; aśraddadhānaḥ – the faithless; ca – and; ◆
saṁśaya-ātmā – the doubting soul; vinaśyati – goes to ruin; ◆ na – not; ayam –
this; lokaḥ – world; asti – is; na paraḥ – nor the next; ◆ na sukham – nor
happiness; saṁśaya-ātmanaḥ – for the doubting soul

**But the ignorant man, the faithless man, the doubting man
goes to destruction. For the doubting self, there is no
happiness either in this world or the next.**

VERSE 4.41

योगसंन्यस्तकर्माणं ज्ञानसञ्छिन्नसंशयम् ।
आत्मवन्तं न कर्माणि निबध्नन्ति धनञ्जय ॥ 41 ॥

yogasamnyastakarmāṇam
jñānachinnasaṁśayam |
ātmavantam na karmāṇi
nibadnanti dhanañjaya ||

◆ yoga-samnyasta-karmāṇam – who has renounced actions through Yoga; ◆
jñāna-chinna-saṁśayam – whose doubts are rent asunder by knowledge; ◆
ātmavantam – possessed of the Self/self-possession; na – not; karmāṇi – actions;
◆ nibadnanti – bind; dhanañjaya – O Dhananjaya (Arjuna).

O Arjuna! Actions do not bind the man who has surrendered the fruits of karma by yoga, whose doubts are cleared by Knowledge, and who is firmly established in the Self.